

Question:

A 17-year-old teenager is brought to the emergency department with severe bleeding from his right hand. He was involved in a gang fight about 30 minutes ago where he received a penetrating stab wound by a sharp knife in the region of the ‘anatomical snuffbox’. A vascular surgeon is called in for consultation. Damage to which artery is most likely responsible for his excessive bleeding?

Answer Choices:

- A. Radial artery
- B. Ulnar artery
- C. Princeps pollicis artery
- D. Brachial artery

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The anatomical snuffbox is a region near the thumb and index finger , and it contains several important structures including the superficial palmar arch and the deep palmar arch . The deep palmar arch is a network of deep palmar arteries that run in the snuffbox region . Damage to this artery is likely to cause excessive bleeding . </think><answer> Deep palmar arch </answer>

